

Hearing

Our ears detect sound waves that pass through the air. The sense of hearing allows us to recognize a vast range of sounds and to communicate using speech.

Inside the ear

The ear has three parts. The outer ear collects sound waves. In the middle ear, the sound travels as vibrations along tiny bones called ossicles. The inner ear contains a coiled cochlea that detects the vibrations and sends signals to the brain.

Ear flap directs sound into the ear canal

Cartilage provides support to the ear flap

Ear lobe is filled with fatty tissue

Skull bone

Outer ear canal carries sound waves toward the eardrum

Outer ear

